

Hosting Manual

Deploying to cPanel · www.hausaly.com/nusuk

How the platform was deployed to <https://www.hausaly.com/nusuk/> on **Truehost cPanel (Web Hosting Starter)** using *Setup Node.js App*. Follow this to deploy it again, move it, or recover it.

1. What you are deploying

Item	Detail
App	Node.js web app (site + request forms + admin dashboard)
Dependencies	None (no <code>npm install</code> needed)
Node version	22.13 or newer (uses built-in SQLite). Truehost offers 22.23.3
Database	One SQLite file: <code>nusuk.db</code> (kept outside the code folder)
Entry file	<code>app.cjs</code>
URL path	<code>/nusuk</code> (set with <code>BASE_PATH</code>)

Before you start, confirm:

- ☐ cPanel has **Setup Node.js App** (search "node" in cPanel's tool search)
- ☐ The version list includes **22.13+**
- ☐ The domain's DNS already points to the hosting (A record = the server IP)
- ☐ You have the project ZIP from GitHub

If either of the first two is missing, the app cannot run on that plan — ask the host to enable Node 22, or use a VPS (Appendix A).

2. Folder layout (cPanel home = `/home/<cpanel-user>`)

```
/home/<cpanel-user>/
├─ nusuk/                ← APPLICATION ROOT (code lives here)
│   ├── app.cjs           ← startup file
│   ├── package.json
│   ├── server/           ← index.js, db.js, auth.js, validate.js, config.js
│   ├── public/           ← index.html, css/, js/, img/
│   └─ test/
├─ nusuk-data/           ← DATABASE (created automatically; never delete)
└─ public_html/          ← your main website (not touched)
```

Golden rule: the files `app.cjs`, `server/`, `public/` must sit **directly** inside `nusuk/`, not in a sub-folder.

3. First-time deployment

Step 1 — Download the project

1. Open the GitHub repository → choose the branch → **Code** → **Download ZIP**.
2. You get `Nusuk-<branch>.zip`.

Step 2 — Upload the code

1. cPanel → **File Manager**.
2. Go to `/home/<cpanel-user>` and create a folder named `nusuk`.
3. Open `nusuk` → **Upload** → select the ZIP.
4. Right-click the ZIP → **Extract** (into `/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk`).
5. Open the new folder (`Nusuk-<branch>`), **Select All** → **Move** to `/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk`. (Turn on **Settings** → **Show Hidden Files** first.)
6. Delete the empty extracted folder and the ZIP.
7. Check the layout matches section 2.

Step 3 — Create the Node.js app

cPanel → **Setup Node.js App** → **Create Application**:

Field	Value
Node.js version	22.x (e.g. 22.23.3)
Application mode	Production
Application root	nusuk
Application URL	pick your domain, and type nusuk in the path box next to it
Application startup file	app.cjs

⚠ Do not leave the path box empty — the site will return 404.

Environment variables (Add variable for each):

Name	Value	Meaning
BASE_PATH	/nusuk	Serve under /nusuk
HTTPS	1	Secure cookies (site must use https)
ADMIN_EMAIL	your email	First administrator login
ADMIN_PASSWORD	a strong password (10+ chars)	First administrator password
DATA_DIR	/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk-data	Database location (outside public_html)

Click **Create**, then **Start/Restart**.

ADMIN_EMAIL / ADMIN_PASSWORD are only read the **first time** the app starts. Change the password later in **Dashboard → Users**, not here.

Step 4 — Fix the .htaccess (required on Truehost)

Truehost adds a WordPress rewrite block that sends every non-file URL to a missing `index.php`. That blocks the app's API (`/nusuk/api/...`) and gives a 404.

1. File Manager → **Settings** → **Show Hidden Files**.
2. Find the `.htaccess` that contains lines starting `PassengerAppRoot` (cPanel created it when you made the app — in `public_html` or `public_html/nusuk`).
3. **Copy** it first as a backup (`.htaccess.bak`).
4. Edit it and **delete only** the block shown below.

```
# BEGIN WordPress
RewriteEngine On
RewriteBase /
RewriteRule ^index\.php$ - [L]
RewriteCond %{REQUEST_FILENAME} !-f
RewriteCond %{REQUEST_FILENAME} !-d
RewriteRule . /index.php [L]
# END WordPress
```

Keep the Passenger lines, the HTTPS redirect and the security rules, then continue:

5. Save, then **Restart** the Node app.

Step 5 — Verify

1. Open `https://www.<domain>/nusuk/api/health` → must show `{"ok":true}`.
2. Open `https://www.<domain>/nusuk/` (keep the trailing slash) → the site loads.
3. Open `/nusuk/#/login` → sign in with `ADMIN_EMAIL` / `ADMIN_PASSWORD`.
4. **Immediately** change the admin password: **Dashboard** → **Users** → **Edit**.
5. Submit a test request on the Interest Form and confirm it appears in **Dashboard** → **Service Requests**.

4. First-time setup inside the dashboard

1. **Users** → change your password; add staff accounts if needed (`staff` cannot see Users/Settings).
2. **Settings** → **Platform FX rate** → enter Naira per 1 Saudi Riyal (shown in the top bar; hidden until set).
3. **Settings** → **Brochures / YouTube** → add the links (buttons stay disabled until filled).
4. Replace the **Privacy Policy** placeholder text before launch (`public/js/app.js`, `privacy` view).

5. Updating the live site (after new changes)

1. **Back up** `/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk-data/nusuk.db` (File Manager → Download).
2. Download the new ZIP from GitHub.
3. In `/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk` **delete**: folders `public`, `server`, `test`; files `app.cjs`, `package.json`, `README.md`, `Dockerfile`. **Never delete**: `tmp`, and the separate `nusuk-data` folder.
4. Upload the ZIP → Extract → Select All inside the extracted folder → **Move** to `nusuk` → delete the leftovers.
5. **Setup Node.js App** → **Restart**.
6. Test `/nusuk/api/health`, then hard-refresh the site (**Ctrl+Shift+R**).

Only changed `public/` files (HTML/CSS/JS/images)? No restart is needed — upload and hard-refresh. Changed anything in `server/` or `app.cjs`? Restart the app.

6. Backups and recovery

- **Back up:** download `nusuk-data/nusuk.db` regularly (weekly, and before every update). It holds all requests, bookings, users, inventory and settings.
 - **Restore:** upload the saved `nusuk.db` back into `nusuk-data/` and restart the app.
 - **Lost admin password:** in File Manager, rename `nusuk-data/nusuk.db` to `nusuk.db.old`, set new `ADMIN_EMAIL` / `ADMIN_PASSWORD` variables, restart (a new empty database and admin are created). Re-import is not automatic — keep the old file for reference.
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7. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
<code>hausaly.com/nusuk/</code> → black 404 page	Application URL path empty, or code one folder too deep	Set path <code>nusuk</code> and Save; fix layout (section 2)
Page loads but login says "Request failed"	App not receiving API calls (WordPress rule in <code>.htaccess</code>) or app not running	Step 4; Restart; check <code>/api/health</code>
<code>/api/health</code> → 404	Same as above	Step 4
<code>/api/health</code> → 500/503 or "Incomplete response"	App crashed on start	Open <code>nusuk/stderr.log</code> and <code>nusuk/boot.log</code> in File Manager
No <code>boot.log</code> appears	cPanel is not running <code>app.cjs</code>	Check startup file name, application root, app is Started
Login works but you are logged out at once	<code>HTTPS=1</code> but visiting <code>http://</code>	Use <code>https://</code>
Old design still showing	Browser cache	Ctrl+Shift+R
<code>.htaccess</code> block comes back	Truehost regenerated it	Repeat Step 4
Node version list tops out below 22	Plan limitation	Ask the host to enable Node 22, or use a VPS

Diagnostic files (in `/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk/`):

- `boot.log` — written by `app.cjs`: startup info, errors, first 30 requests.
- `stderr.log` — written by cPanel: the app's error output. Delete both once everything works.

Useful checks

- Health: `/nusuk/api/health` → `{"ok":true}`
 - cPanel → **Metrics** → **Errors** shows recent Apache errors.
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8. Security checklist

- ☐ Admin password changed from the one used at first start
- ☐ Never share screenshots showing environment-variable values (they include the password)
- ☐ `DATA_DIR` is **outside** `public_html`
- ☐ Site is served over **https** and `HTTPS=1` is set
- ☐ Staff accounts use the `staff` role, not `admin`
- ☐ Database backed up and stored off the server

Appendix A — Deploying on a VPS instead (Docker)

```
git clone https://github.com/<owner>/Nusuk && cd Nusuk
docker build -t nusuk-consult .
docker run -d --name nusuk --restart=always -p 127.0.0.1:3000:3000 -v nusuk-data:/data \
  -e BASE_PATH=/nusuk -e HTTPS=1 -e ADMIN_EMAIL=you@example.com -e
  ADMIN_PASSWORD='StrongPassword' nusuk-consult
```

Reverse-proxy `/nusuk` (path unchanged) to `127.0.0.1:3000`:

```
# Caddy
www.example.com { handle /nusuk* { reverse_proxy 127.0.0.1:3000 } }
```

```
# nginx
location /nusuk/ { proxy_pass http://127.0.0.1:3000; proxy_set_header Host $host;
proxy_set_header X-Forwarded-For $remote_addr; }
location = /nusuk { return 301 /nusuk/; }
```

Leave `BASE_PATH` empty to serve at the domain root or on a subdomain.

Appendix B — Environment variable reference

Variable	Default	Purpose
<code>PORT</code>	3000	Listening port (cPanel/Passenger overrides it)
<code>DATA_DIR</code>	<code>./data</code>	Folder for <code>nusuk.db</code>
<code>BASE_PATH</code>	<i>(empty)</i>	Sub-path, e.g. <code>/nusuk</code>
<code>HTTPS</code>	0	<code>1</code> = secure cookies, trust proxy headers
<code>ADMIN_EMAIL</code>	<code>admin@nusuk.com.ng</code>	First admin email (first start only)
<code>ADMIN_PASSWORD</code>	<i>(random, printed once)</i>	First admin password (first start only)
<code>NOTIFY_WEBHOOK_URL</code>	<i>(empty)</i>	Optional JSON notification on each new request/booking

Appendix C — Quick reference

```
Site:           https://www.hausaly.com/nusuk/
Admin login:    https://www.hausaly.com/nusuk/#/login
Health:        https://www.hausaly.com/nusuk/api/health
App root:       /home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk      startup file: app.cjs
Database:       /home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk-data/nusuk.db
Restart:       cPanel → Setup Node.js App → Restart
```